

Inventory & Supplies Management

Organization: Morrison Mentors

Document: Problem Statement

Date: November 2025

1. Context & Scope

- Process Affected: Lesson Planning & Materials Retrieval
- Stakeholders Impacted: STEM Instructors, Site Coordinators, Inventory Operations

2. Current State

Current Workflow: Instructors review lesson plans, estimate required supply quantities based on personal judgment, manually write down a pick list, and physically search the basement inventory to locate items.

3. Problem & Root Causes

- Lack of Standardization: Lesson plan documents do not contain standardized, pre-defined supply specifications or exact item counts.
- Lack of Inventory Visibility: There is no centralized tracking system to show item locations or real-time stock levels prior to physical retrieval.
- Process Dependency: Kit assembly relies entirely on individual staff familiarity with physical space and personal estimation.

4. Business Impact

- Operational Inefficiency: Significant instructor and staff hours are wasted manually auditing and searching physical inventory.
- Instructional Risk: Misestimates and missing items lead to incomplete lesson kits, disrupting classroom execution.
- Inventory Decay: Uncoordinated basement searches create disorganization, leading to lost stock, duplicate purchases, and unaccounted shrinkage.

5. Problem Statement Summary

Morrison Mentors needs a consistent way to identify, locate, prepare, and verify lesson materials. Because kit assembly relies on manual physical searches and individual staff estimation, the organization incurs unnecessary labor waste, frequent supply discrepancies during instruction, and poor inventory organization.